Union Conference Record

"Be strong all ye people, saith the Lord, and work; for I am with you."

Vol. 11. No. 50. SYDNEY, MONDAY, DECEMBER 16, 1907. Registered at the General Post Office, Sydney, for transmission by Post as a Newspaper

"WERE HALF THE POWER."

Were half the power that fills the world with terror,
Were half the wealth bestowed on camps and courts,
Given to redeem the human mind from error,
There were no need of arsenals or forts.

The warrior's name would be a name abhorred;
And every nation that should lift again
Its hand against a brother, on its forehead
Would wear forevermore the curse of Cain.

Down the dark future, through long generations,
The echoing sounds grow fainter and then cease;
And, like a bell, with solemn, sweet vibrations,
I hear once more the voice of Christ say "Peace!"

—*Longfellow.*

Sowing beside All Waters.

THE commission that Christ gave to His disciples was not merely for the building up of His cause in a few places. Every nation in the earth was to have the light of sacred truth. The churches that have not been light-bearers to some needy part of the Lord's vineyard, have failed to fulfill the commission of Christ.

Had the money and labor that have been given to the cause in other lands been confined to the work in the home land, the church would have lost materially in spiritual life. God has been honored by the work that has been done for the people in distant lands. We must increase our liberalities to missions. And while we increase our labor and gifts for foreign fields, we must not neglect the work that needs to be done at home.

Our field is the world. Repeat it again and again. Our field is the world. We rejoice for those who have made a willing offering of their property to the Lord. We encourage all to help with their means in the cause of God. Christians who are fully awake to the needs of the work, will not spend the Lord's money needlessly. They will consider the great missionary field to be worked, and viewing their obligations in the light of the cross of Calvary, they will consider no sacrifice too great to make for Him who gave His life for the life of the world.

The Lord is calling upon His people to take up different lines of missionary work. Church-members are to do evangelistic work in the homes of their friends and neighbors who have not received full evidence of the truth. The presentation of the truth in love and sympathy, from house to house, is in harmony with the instruction that Christ gave to His disciples when He sent them out on their first missionary tour. By songs of praise to God, by humble, heartfelt prayers, by simple presentation of Bible truth in the family circle, many will be reached. The divine worker will be present to send conviction to hearts. "I am with you alway," is His promise. With the assurance of the abiding presence of such a helper, we may labor with faith and hope and courage.

All who surrender themselves to God in unselfish service for humanity are in coöperation with the Lord of glory. This thought sweetens all toil, it braces the will, it nerves the spirit for whatever may befall. Working with unselfish heart, ennobled by being partakers of Christ's sufferings, sharing His sympathies, they help to swell the tide of His joy, and bring honor and praise to His exalted name.

Precious are God's promises to those who minister in His name. He says, "Then shall thy light break forth as the morning, and thine health shall spring forth speedily." Thy light shall "rise in obscurity, and thy darkness be as the noonday: and the Lord shall guide thee continually, and satisfy thy soul in drought, and make fat thy bones; and thou shalt be like a watered garden, and like a spring of water, whose waters fail not."

ELLEN G. WHITE.

Sanitarium, Cal., July 11, 1907.

Hedged In.

GEORGE MULLER says, "God's way leads always into trial so far as sight and sense are concerned. Nature always will be tried in God's ways." Again he tells us, "We love the easy days, the pleasant days, but trials are what faith feeds upon." So we see the divine necessity of our close places. They are a needful discipline for the development of a faith that can walk before the unseen God in steadfast confidence and obedience, no matter what that may involve. But we naturally think quite the opposite, and expect an unobstructed path in the way of God's leading.

We forget that when the Master constrained the disciples to get into the boat and go across the lake after the feeding of the five thousand, He led them right into the teeth of a tempest. "It was now dark, and Jesus was not come to them," is the first graphic stroke of the picture. Then they are toiling in midsea, making no headway, the winds contrary unto them, until the fourth watch of the night—and still Jesus has not come. They could not see Him, but He saw them, and let the trial of baffling winds and waves continue until flesh and heart were ready to fail. Then He came walking over that storm-tossed sea, giving relief, and revealing His presence. They never had had anything quite like that, and out of it there came a new and never-to-be-forgotten manifestation of Christ's power and love.

For Israel in the wilderness every foot of the way was divinely chosen, but their journey was one series of

testings, with here and there a respite, as at Elim. Their provings were never fancied difficulties. It was the continued story of man's extremity and God's opportunity. We read it, and say to ourselves, O, if they had but trusted in the dark every time and never murmured, what a grand record they would have made! How faith would have grown with each added proving, until at Kadesh-barnea they would boldly have crossed over to take walled cities, overcome giants, and possess the land!

Hedged in at Pi-hahiroth and pursued, there really was no way. They had yet to learn that God can make a way where there is none, and that with Him there are no providential impossibilities. Their straits were seldom, if ever, precisely duplicated. There was always with them, as there is with us, some new feature, so that they could say in memory of past deliverances, "But this is different; we have not passed this way before." Well would it have been for them, and well would it be for us, to remember our Father can not be surprised by circumstances. He is as equal to the altered conditions as to the previous trial.

If you walk in providential darkness, stand still, as George Muller again would say, and wait to see what God is doing for you behind the clouds. He has not forsaken them that seek Him (Ps. 9:10.) If you have come to Marah, and the waters are so bitter that you can not drink, don't question His goodness, but trust; and Marah, with its sweetened waters, will be a memorable spot in your pligrimage.

"Say not, my soul, From whence
Can God relieve my care?
Remember that Omnipotence
Hath servants everywhere.
His methods are sublime,
His heart profoundly kind.
God never is before His time,
And never is behind."

—*Selected.*

"CERTAINTY of every victory wins battles in character-building long before they are fought."

"HEATHENISM in India is vile; in China, defiant; in Japan, desperate; in Korea, indifferent; in Africa, triumphant."

"THE world is very busy; to get a hearing you must be able to create the impression that what you have to say is more important than business."

Our Mission Field.

COMFORT ONE ANOTHER.

Comfort one another;
For the way is growing dreary,
The feet are often weary,
And the heart is very sad,
There is heavy burden-bearing,
When it seems that none are caring,
And we half forget that ever we were glad.

Comfort one another,
With the hand-clasp close and tender,
With the sweetness love can render,
And the looks of friendly eyes.
Do not wait with grace unspoken,
While life's daily bread is broken;
Gentle speech is oft like manna from the skies.

Comfort one another,
By the hope of Him who sought us
In our peril—Him who bought us,
Paying with His precious blood;
By the faith that will not alter,
Trusting strength that shall not falter,
Leaning on the One divinely good.

Comfort one another;
Let the grave-gloom lie behind you,
While the Spirit's words remind you
Of the home beyond the tomb,
Where no more is pain or parting,
Fever's flush or tear-drop starting,
But the presence of the Lord, and for all His people room.

—*Mrs. Margaret E. Sangster.*

Fiji.

I HAVE spent a month in Lau since my last report. I had a nice, quiet time. The brethren there are all of good courage, and seem to be making advancement in the message. One chiefly man, who had not paid tithe for a long time, came out firm again on the side of truth. Several others from the outside are about to take their stand for the truth. These we labored for while we were located in Lau. A European lady, for whom we also labored, while in Lau, is trembling in the balance. I had a number of good readings with her. She seemed to drink the truth in like one who was famishing. All the brethren in Lau pledged themselves to take a number of our partial translation of a portion of the "Great Controversy" to sell in the month of December. All seemed to enter heartily into the spirit of getting our publications before the people as quickly as possible. We are thankful for this spirit, for we realize that this is what will help us to publish the truth quickly throughout this field. Pray that our brethren here may be true to their vows.

On returning home to Buresala I found Brother and Sister Stewart, who have come to take the place of Brother and Sister Carr, who have been called to open the work in New Guinea. They are taking hold nobly, and give promise of quickly acquiring the language of this people. They like their new surroundings, and best of all they believe that this is the field to which the Lord has called them.

We were glad to welcome Brother and Sister Steed amongst us, and to know that now our Samoan field is to have help. They seem to be of very good courage in the work to which they have been called. They like their island environments very much. We pray God's blessing upon them, and the field to which they are going.

Our dear Sister Carr leaves us today for Sydney. We are sorry to lose her from our number. She has endeared herself to the work here by the ties of love and self-sacrifice. We are glad, on the other hand, that Fiji is able to give her best to start the work in New Guinea. Our prayers go with her. Brethren, what a glad day it will be, when the work is finished, and the workers are gathered home with their sheaves from all lands. Let us be intensely in earnest in our work that it may be hastened to the finish.

C. H. PARKER.

Arrival in Singapore.

LETTERS have been received by the *Airlie* from Nurse Mabel Lewes, of Singapore. Some quotations from these letters will doubtless prove interesting to our readers. After relating the incidents of a most pleasant voyage, she gives an account of their arrival at Sourabaya, Java, where Sister Skadsheim met them, looking very well considering her recent severe illness. Brother and Sister Fox also welcomed them. The Teasdales were away on a short visit to the mountains to recruit.

After some delay, while Sister Nordstrom's luggage was being sorted over by the customs officials, they drove to the Mission house. She says:—

Oh, the drive! We couldn't turn our heads about fast enough. The natives swarm everywhere, lying all along the roadsides with their goods for sale. Life, life, in all directions! Children are being

fed, men having their hair cut, others eating, drinking,—and all in the open.

The Mission house is built in Eastern style. The porch and rooms are large, lofty, and cool; all is as much open as possible. They have in all the houses just the least amount of furniture they can do with. Consequently the houses look bare, but cool, if anything could be so!

They rested, had a real Adventist meal once more, and after worship, drove round to see the sights. Sister Lewes further says:—

Words fail to express one's impressions of the place, for it is more like fairy-land than anything else. We passed lovely villas; gardens rich with highly colored and scentful flowers; and a stream of people walking, driving, or cycling in the cool of the evening, some beautifully dressed in light evening gowns. Then the moon rose, making the scene lovelier and more fairy-like than ever. We drove by the market, where was every possible odor. I think if one got lost, he could always find his way back here. I never enjoyed anything more than that wonderful drive. But with all the brilliancy and gaiety of the scene, I could not suppress a feeling of sadness. For the people are living day after day for nothing but just the pleasures of the present moment. Also poor souls, who, for the most part, are hurrying on to eternity without a thought of God or the future life! What a terrible awakening will come to them some day! What light, what privileges we have! and what responsibility rests upon us to give this light to others!

At Singapore, which they reached on October 26, they were met by Sister Gates and Brother and Sister Jones, and heartily welcomed, and much struck with the beautiful tropical surroundings,—lovely trees, flowers, and green lawns. They were also much pleased with the splendid roads, fine buildings, etc. The newly acquired house, with grounds, out of Singapore, is a fine, lofty, cool mansion, well situated, and having a magnificent view. On Sunday, the twenty-eighth, the wedding of Brother Joseph Mills with Sister Nettie Carswell took place. It was quite an ideal little wedding in ideal surroundings. The guests were chiefly Chinese and other converts. Brother Gates brought in the bride, and Brother Jones performed the ceremony, after which light refreshments were served, and the happy pair departed.

On the following day, Nurse Lewes was called to see a lady who was very sick; and to attend to several others during the following day. Some she could not treat while the doctor (Chinese) was giving drugs. One improved greatly after some treatment, and was full of gratitude. Of the medical work she writes:—

They tell me I shall soon have my hands full. May the One who went about healing the sick be by my side to give me the wisdom and strength needed for this great work. I realize something of the responsibility of being a true representative of this medical missionary work.

In conclusion she mentions having purchased a bicycle, which she finds very useful in going to and fro to visit those needing her; and to the Mission house which is three miles from the School, where she is at present staying.

Our Maori Mission.

HAVING been asked by the Union Conference Council to connect with our New Zealand School, I thought the readers of the *Messenger* would be interested in a report of the work before I relinquish it. During the past winter, owing to the almost impassable nature of the roads, we were circumscribed in our work, being able to visit those parts only which are in the immediate vicinity of Gisborne. The roads, under the influence of westerly winds, are now rapidly drying, so our workers will soon be able to visit any place in the country.

During the winter, Brother Redward removed with his family to Tologa Bay. His recent letters show that he has his hands full of work in ministering to sick natives. The amount of sickness met with during the past winter has been very great, both amongst the *pakehas* and natives. Pneumonia, whooping cough, measles, and other complaints, besides the dreadful "white plague," which carries off so many of the Maoris. It is evident that our workers amongst the Maoris should know how to deal with these issues, and thus many openings will be furnished them to present other phases of the gospel.

Our Maori paper, *Te Karere o te Pono*, which was published in July, has now reached its fourth number. Through the blessings of the Lord it seems to be making friends wherever it goes. The Maoris are a reading people, and we believe that their hearts will be reached mainly by means of our literature. Our subscribers list is now well over 100. A few of these names have been sent in by our people in other parts of the Dominion, but most of them are the names of Maoris from the Gisborne and Tologa Bay *pas*. We have found it necessary to work these *pas* systematically and thoroughly. To do this has necessitated frequent visits, as it is very seldom, if ever, that one finds all the natives at home. But we feel sure that the coming summer will find our subscription list mounting up to 500 or 600.

We are thankful for the coöperation of our people in circulating the paper thus far, and we trust that all will still render assistance in this way whenever possible. Our free list contains about eighty names. These are mainly the names of chiefs or persons of influence in various parts. This does not include the good work being done in this way by Sister Mackenzie at Cambridge, and Sister Johnstone at Wellington.

A good bundle of our papers has been sent each month to Dr. Gibson, in the Chatham Islands, and Sister Gibson writes that the natives are greatly interested, and she is sending the names of subscribers. Here is the literal translation of a letter which was received the other day from a Maori north of Auckland:—

"Dear Sir,—

"I send this that for me might be sent one of *Te Karere o te Pono*, if indeed this is the price, 1s 6d for the year. This part is clear for you, if I am mistaken and the money shouldbe sent first, you must write a letter. Because great is my praise of these books whose talk leads us continually to our Father in heaven. This is all the reason I wrote. Good health to you."

By this time he has probably received both papers and tracts, and we shall await his reply with interest.

The other evening we attended a meeting held under the auspices of the Church of England, to endeavor to obtain public sympathy in favor of giving the Maoris the local option vote. It is asked that in every Maori electorate the Maoris shall have the privilege of voting as to whether they wish the drink sold or not. If a majority decides that drink shall not be sold, then the publicans in that district are prohibited from selling any intoxicating drink to Maoris. This is not to interfere with the voting or rights of European electors in any way. It is also asked that the law shall be enforced that provides that no one shall take liquor

from any licensed house to give to Maoris for consumption off the premises.

The meeting was addressed by a young native minister, Mr. Bennett, and by a Maori lady, Miss Heta Stirling. These made earnest appeals to the Europeans present to help them to save their fellow-countrymen from the wretchedness which alcohol was working amongst them. It was the most pitiable sight I had seen for many years—these poor Maori children in their helplessness asking the white man to save them from the terrors he had brought. It made me ashamed that my nation was responsible for such a sin.

It seems that half-castes are already allowed to vote, but full-blooded Maoris are denied that privilege on the local option question. Yet it often happens that the latter are much finer specimens of humanity in every way. I trust that our people throughout the Dominion will do all in their power to lend a helping hand to the Maori that he may free himself from this curse. There is no doubt that the hotels along the East Coast are working sad havoc amongst the Maoris, and in many cases depend almost wholly on Maori money.

We are thankful for the experience we have had amongst these people whom we love, and in going to Cambridge it is with the hope that we may be used of God in helping to train some of our young people for this needy work. Workers should be placed as soon as possible in various parts of New Zealand. We have lost much by delay. We trust the rich blessings of the Lord may rest upon Brethren Carswell and Redward as they carry on the work. There seem to be several places round Gisborne where meetings could be held right away. We understand that as soon as Brother Carswell arrives, plans will be laid for working during this summer and autumn.

Pray on for our Maori Mission.

W. J. SMITH.

"A RELIGION that does not govern us according to the pattern of Christ in this life, will not give us an abundant entrance into the heavenly kingdom in the world to come. A religion that does not separate us from sinful acts here in this life, will not separate us from sinners in the great day of reckoning hereafter."

OUR FIELD WORK.

The Experiences of Five Sabbaths.

ON October 12, my wife and I spent our last Sabbath with the friends in Queensland. Our meeting was held at the tent in Toowoomba, and here we bade farewell to many of the dear brethren and sisters. Others met us at the train the following Thursday en route to Sydney. In the meantime the writer went to Brisbane to send our heavy luggage by water to Sydney, and said good-bye to a few of the friends in that city.

Arriving in Sydney we spent the Sabbath at the Willoughby Camp, where the largest gathering of Seventh-day Adventists yet held in Australia was convened. Pastor Olsen spoke in the forenoon, and Pastor Fulton in the afternoon. Many responded to the call to seek a higher experience by going forward for prayer, and in the afternoon gave thanks in testimony meeting for the loving-kindness of God.

Leaving Sydney on the *Mokoia* we spent our next Sabbath at sea before reaching Auckland. We had a beautiful trip, and enjoyed the privilege of presenting some phases of truth to several persons on board. One of these privileges was enjoyed on the Sabbath, and on the whole a pleasant day was spent, though the Sabbath was not recognized by more than three on board,—Miss Emma Hill, my wife, and myself.

After reaching Auckland we paid a visit for some days to the new School at Cambridge. It is a beautiful place, and seems well suited for a school and farm. Here we also spent one of God's holy days, meeting some brethren and sisters for the first time, and renewing old acquaintances. Leaving Cambridge we proceeded with Pastor Cobb to Gisborne, and were introduced to our future field of labor. After visiting a Maori village on Friday, we met with the Gisborne Church on the Sabbath, and heard an impressive address by Pastor Cobb on the shortness of time, and the importance of the work in which we are called to engage. Afterwards, during the week that followed, Pastor Cobb visited Tologa Bay, and found several persons among the Maori people much interested in the truths which he presented. We believe God has jewels among this people, and we ask the prayers of God's people that we may find these jewels, and be His instruments in bringing them to Christ.

W. R. CARSWELL.

Guildford Tent Mission.

IN harmony with the decision of the Conference Committee, at the close of the recent camp-meeting we moved our family to Guildford, and prepared for the present tent effort. Our new tent arrived in due course, and we lost no time in getting it pitched and ready for meetings.

After thoroughly billing the place with a neat announcement of our meetings, with a facsimile of the prophetic chart clearly depicted in the centre, we opened up on Sunday evening, November 10, with a good congregation of our own people and about fifty outsiders, who manifested a good interest in the theme of "Christ's Second Coming," the subject chosen for the opening address.

We are now in the third week of our effort, and the interest has not only been maintained, but increased. Last Sunday evening, November 24, every available seat was occupied, and between thirty-five and forty stood outside around the tent, the subject being "Modern Spiritualism." Our hearts greatly rejoice at this manifest token of God's presence and blessing with us in our work, and we gladly give to Him all the praise, and seek His face for that humility of soul that He can use to His own honor and glory.

As might be expected, the enemy is not satisfied with keeping quiet; while the Spirit of God is at work for the salvation of souls, he is busy trying to throw dust in their eyes, that they should not see the truth. So the Church of England curate, who is quite a youth, has been led to preach against us, and attack our position on the conditional immortality of the soul. As there are quite a number of his congregation who are interested in the truth, we decided to review his sermon in the tent the following Tuesday evening. Our tent was packed, every available seat being occupied. Half as many again were outside. We sought the Lord earnestly that the spirit of Christ might be manifested in our

reply, that the truth might triumph in the minds of the congregation. At the close several expressed their appreciation of the matter presented, and their conviction of the truth.

Next Sunday, December 1, we present the Sabbath Question, and while praising God for His help and guidance in the past, we seek His help and blessing for the future, that souls may be won for His kingdom.

W. G. BRITTAIN.

Young People's Work.

WORK FOR ALL.

"We can not all be preachers, and sway
with voice and pen,
As strong winds sway the forest, the
minds and hearts of men;
But we can be evangels to souls within
our reach;
There's always love's own gospel for
loving hearts to preach.

"We can not all be heroes, and thrill a
hemisphere
With some great, daring venture, some
deed that mocks at fear;
But we can fill a lifetime with kindly
acts and true;
There's always noble service for noble
souls to do."

The Missionary Volunteer Reading Course.

THE art of reading admits us to the whole world of thought. It permits us to associate with the wisest and best people, and gather information otherwise entirely beyond our reach. Doubtless many have felt like the author of an old English song, who said:—

"O for a booke and a shady nooke
Either indoors or out;
With the grene leaves whispering over-
head,
Or the strete cryes all about,
Where I may read all at my ease,
Both of the new and olde;
For a jollie booke whereon to looke,
Is better to me than golde."

Yet have you ever observed how few read to a purpose? It is a fact that thousands, through wrong habits of reading, not only receive no good, but great harm. Some read in a careless, desultory fashion, and others seem to read for quantity rather than quality, racing through many books with little thought except for the present amusement. Such become veritable mental inebriates. Many do not stop to question the character of a book or its author.

Do you, dear reader, realize that the choice of books, like the choice of friends, is a serious duty; that we are as responsible for what we read as for what we do?

It is to assist our young people in the choice of good reading, and to provide means of home culture, that the Young People's Missionary Volunteer Department of the General Conference has been asked to conduct a reading course.

There is nothing so interesting or important to-day as the history of the great conflict between Christ and Satan down through the ages, and its present development in the foreign mission field, under the sounding of the third angel's message. The first book studied will be "Early Writings" by Mrs. E. G. White, a most fascinating story of the early experiences and views of this chosen servant of the Lord, and a brief story of the whole controversy between good and evil. This will furnish a good foundation for further study of the Spirit of Prophecy, as well as prepare us for the other books of the course.

The second book will be "Into All the World," by Amos R. Wells,—a book written for young people, giving a brief survey of the world-wide mission field, and sketches of the principal missionaries who have labored in the various fields. This book will be supplemented by a map study, and a consideration of our own missions.

The third book is "Pastor Hsi (She), One of China's Christians," the life story of this, perhaps the most remarkable native Christian worker yet developed in China. He was a wicked Confucian scholar, a hater of Christianity. In a remarkable way he was converted, and spent the remainder of his life in earnest labor in the opium refugee and evangelistic work.

Remarkable examples are given of answers to prayer, in the healing of the sick, and casting out of evil spirits. This book is written in a very fascinating way, and can not fail to interest every one. It brings the reader nearer to the actual work of preaching the gospel in China than do most books on Chinese missions.

The importance of this reading course for our young people can scarcely be overestimated. "It is acquaintance that awakens sympathy, and sympathy is the spring of effective ministry. To awaken in the children and youth sympathy and the spirit of sacrifice for the suffering millions in the regions beyond, let them become acquainted with these lands and their people. . . . Instead of dwelling on the exploits of the Alexanders and Napoleons of history, let the pupils study the lives of such men as the apostle Paul and Martin Luther, as Moffat, and Livingstone, and Carey, and the present daily unfolding missionary effort."—*Education, p. 269.*

All heaven is astir, and the theme of earnest consideration there, is the finishing of the work of salvation in this world. For this, Jesus gave His life, and to-day He ministers in the heavenly sanctuary. What a privilege that we can unite with Jesus and the angels in the work of reclaiming the lost! It means full consecration and diligent preparation. "Study to shew thyself approved unto God, a workman that needeth not to be ashamed." As missionary volunteers, we must understand our mission field,—the world,—and know something of the manner in which the work is to be done.

Most of you know something of the great generals of the world, and of the great battles that have been fought in bloody strife. You know something of the relative strength of the great world powers to-day, and what the national and international political issues are. Are you acquainted with the lives of the men who have fought the battles of the Lord? Are you acquainted with the great spiritual conflicts and conquests? Do you appreciate the reports that come from our fellow-workers in the advent message who are at the front?

Information is the key to interest. "Know, and you will feel; know, and you will pray; know, and you will help. You will be ashamed of the sluggishness, of the isolation, of the selfishness which has made you think only of your own people and your father's house."

This course will begin in the RECORD of January 6, 1908, and will continue eight months. There is no expense, except the cost of the RECORD, books, and map: RECORD, 4s, for one year: "Early Writings," 3s: "Into All the World," cloth, about 2s; paper, about 1s 6d: "Outline of Mission Fields," by the Seventh-day Adventist Mission Board, will be sent free to all who order "Into All the World;" colored map of the

World, showing prevailing religions, about 2s; mounted, about 2s 9d: "Pastor Hsi," cloth, about 4s; paper, about 2s. At the beginning, only the RECORD and "Early Writings" need be procured: the other books can be bought later.

Suggestive questions will appear in the RECORD each week, and at the close of each book, questions will be sent out by the Conference young people's secretaries for written review. All who satisfactorily complete this course, will receive a certificate showing that fact.

Who will join the circle in this our first Missionary Volunteer Reading Course?

Thousands of young people to-day, who do not have the light we enjoy, are studying missions: shall we be behind them? Can you not arrange to take this course? You can if you will. Most people squander as much time in the course of a few years as would be necessary for obtaining a good education.

Order your books and your map of your tract society, and send your name to your Conference young people's secretary for enrollment.

M. E. KERN,

Superintendent of General Conference Young People's Department.

Young People's Work.

THE report of the young people's work for the quarter ending September 30, is certainly encouraging. When we think of the letters written, the pages of tracts loaned and given, the number of papers distributed in various ways, with the other items of work done, we know that a large number of people must have received light on the third angel's message, either as a savor of life unto life, or of death unto death. One very encouraging item is that four persons have accepted the truth through this work. We hope to see this item repeated many times, with increasing numbers.

But though this report is good, it is not what it ought to be. Several of the State secretaries have written that they know a good deal more work was done in some of the societies than was reported. So some have been unfaithful in this. Dear young people, will you not help us by filling up your blank each week, and handing it to your secretary. It is not a great thing we ask of you, but if each one will attend to it, it will greatly facilitate the work of collecting these reports. The effect on your own characters also will be helpful, for the faithful never failing performance of these little regular duties does more to strengthen the character and make it reliable than many people realize. So we will look with confidence to our young people for a far more complete report next quarter.

E. M. GRAHAM.

The Recent Temperance Campaign in Bulahdelah.

THE temperance movement is an important branch of the work of the third angel's message, and the zeal and activity displayed by our people in connection with the recent temperance compaign in New South Wales, was not without its good results. By pen and voice our people had been stimulated by the Spirit of God to action, and their efforts were readily united with those of other ardent advocates of the temperance cause, not of our faith, and all labored together in the most friendly relationship. Our literature, specially prepared for the occasion, found, without apology, acceptance among temperance workers everywhere, and took its place side by side with that furnished by other denominations in the various temperance organizations throughout the State.

Like other places in the Commonwealth at the time, Bulahdelah was fully alive to the value of the golden opportunity that lay within its reach, and that must not be allowed to slip. Members of the various Christian denominations, differing widely in religious belief, forgot their differences, and joined hand to hand and heart to heart, working early and late in the interests of this great temperance movement; and fervent prayers from far and near ascended daily to the throne of grace for the success of the battle against this giant enemy of God and man.

Two talented temperance lecturers visited our district,—Miss Hughes and Mr. Higgins. Both manifested a spirit of self-denial in the advocacy of the cause to which they have devoted themselves to a degree that is most highly commendable, but space forbids entering into details. Mr. Higgins organized a committee and set it to work. The young Methodist minister acted as chairman, and Mrs. Stuttaford as secretary. As before mentioned, all the various Christian denominations in the district were represented by the committee. Meetings were held at my residence, and plans were arranged there for vigorous aggressive work to be done forthwith. The district was divided up and allotted to workers, who went out two and two on foot or by conveyance, to make a thorough canvass of all the residents and to distribute literature, long before the election. This had a good effect in removing objections and prejudice from the minds of many who had been influenced against the cause by its enemies. Many empty arguments which had obtained a firm hold had to be met, such as the loss of revenue to the country by the abolition of the liquor traffic; the injustice of interference by law with consumers, and also with the rights of those interested in the sale of alcoholic drinks; that prohibition does not prohibit; the failure to suppress the traffic completely in those places where the local option law has been applied, etc., etc.

On the Sunday afternoon before the day of the election, permission was obtained to hold a temperance meeting in the recreation grounds. This meeting was well attended. Members of the various Christian denominations took part in the following programme:—

1 Song - - - "Away the Bowl!"
BY THE CHILDREN.
2 Poem - - - "The Two Glasses"
DR. A. STUTTAFORD.
3 Duet - "Look Not upon the Wine"
DR. AND MRS. STUTTAFORD
4 Reading - - "Saving the Nine"
BY THE CHILDREN.
5 Song - - "Launch the Lifeboat!"
6 Reading "I Did Not Intend to Do It"
MRS. JAMES MAYBURY.
7 Song - - - - "Ring It Out!"
DR. A. STUTTAFORD.
8 Reading "Prohibition and the Liquor [Traffic"
9 Quartette - "God Speed the Right"

The programme was selected from our denominational literature. The fourth and sixth items are clippings from the *Review and Herald*. The fifth item is a song by Belden, with the word "gospel" changed to "temperance." The eighth item is from "Ministry of Healing."

Mr. Higgins, and Captain Reid, the local minister, followed with a few brief remarks.

The chair was taken by Mr. Herbert Dee, of the sawmill.

Many spoke in praise of the appropriateness of the programme, and

of the creditable manner in which it was rendered.

On the day of polling the committee was especially busy near the polling place, encouraging some, and endeavoring to set the feet of others out of the way into right paths. The outlying districts in many instances felt confident of victory, but feared for places like Bulahdelah. But Bulahdelah went through with flying colors, to the surprise of almost every one; while those who "lay on their oars," feeling assured of success at home, either lost the day or won by only a narrow majority, and thus helped to bring defeat when the total vote was counted for the whole electorate.

"God desires that now as never before the minds of the people shall be deeply stirred to investigate the *great temperance question*, and the principles underlying true health reform."

This temperance work has placed us in close touch and sympathy with many whom previously we had been unable to reach in Bulahdelah, and it has been an entering wedge to gain access to hearts and homes that may, we trust, be open and ready for the last warning message to the world.

A. STUTTAFORD, M.D.

A Week's United Effort.

TO ALL THE BRETHREN IN NEW SOUTH WALES.

THE New South Wales Conference has voted to set apart the week, December 16-23, for a united effort upon the part of all our people in the sale of "Ministry of Healing."

There is inspiration in union of effort. The people need this book. It contains just the oil the Spirit of God would have poured into human vessels everywhere to-day. And we may be one of the golden pipes through which God will communicate His grace.

The people do not know of this book. They will soon spend their money for that which is of little worth. Will you suggest to your neighbors the thought of purchasing "Ministry of Healing" for a Christmas present? It is beautifully written, illustrated, and printed. We need not be ashamed of it. We may truthfully speak well of it, and the objects for which it is being sold,—to bring a blessing to the home it enters, and to raise a fund for the education and maintenance of medical missionaries in the large cities and in the Pacific islands. These are worthy motives that will appeal to the people. They have already appealed to some. One gentleman, at Chatswood, purchased three copies, and paid £1 2s 6d for them,—one for his wife, one for her mother, and one for his own mother. Others might do just the same if you suggest it to them. Have faith, remembering that "there is nothing too hard for God." "Go forward" with hope and courage. Thrust fear behind you, and God will fill you with courage. "Those who seek to do God's will, investing every talent to the best advantage, will become wise in working for His kingdom. They will learn lessons of the greatest value, and they will feel the highest satisfaction of a rational mind. Peace and grace and power of intellect will be given them." "God has given His people a work to do that will bring about a great and grand result. In getting up out of the easy chair of self-satisfaction, and going forth to give the light of truth to their fellow-men, they will learn an excellent lesson."

As you read these words, respond to them at once: "*As for me, I will do my part. I will not hesitate. I will take the book to my friends and neighbors.* They shall not cast the blame upon me, of their being ignorant of this matter. *I will be God's helping hand.* I will take my stand beside the great unwearied Servant of man's necessity, and work with Him. God helping *me, I will do His work, and I will let Him do all He can through me* in this appointed work."

Read "Ministry of Healing," pages 497-509. Study it, sell it.

Remember the date, December 16-23, and let us all unite in making a big effort at this time.

"Speak unto the children of Israel, that they go forward."

G. B. STARR.

BROTHER CRADDOCK writes: "Last Wednesday, November 27, a severe hailstorm passed over Toowoomba and Gatton. Gatton got the worst of it; some of the hailstones were as large as breakfast cups. Brother Lund suffered severely. Every particle of fruit and every green leaf was cut off the trees; and in two sheets of iron the hail pierced not less than forty-two holes, and every cow came home bleeding. It also killed eighteen fowls. We certainly sympathise with Brother Lund, in the loss that has come to him."

Notes and Personals.

DURING the Christian Endeavor convention recently held in Seattle, Washington, U. S. A., 14,000 copies of the Christian Endeavor Number of *Liberty*, our paper published at Washington, D. C., were distributed. Since that time one brother has placed over 2,200 copies among the lawyers and business men of that city.

AT the recent young people's convention at Mount Vernon, Ohio, U. S. A., the organization of the Young People's Department of the General Conference was perfected. M. E. Kern, of College View, Nebraska, was chosen as chairman, and Miss Matilda Erickson, of Washington, D. C., secretary of the department. The name adopted was the Young People's Society of Missionary Volunteers.

Sanitarium Notes.

MRS. F. W. REEKIE, who underwent a serious operation at the Sanitarium a few weeks ago, made an excellent recovery, and returned to her home Sunday, December 8.

ABOUT ten days after Mrs. Reekie's operation, Mrs. W. Jackson, of Wallsend, also underwent an operation of a somewhat serious nature. She returned to her home December 8.

MISS EDITH FORD is spending a few weeks with some friends at Gordon, and is enjoying much better health since her operation and treatment at the Sanitarium.

NUMBERED among the inmates of the Sanitarium are Brother and Sister J. A. Chaney, of South Africa. Brother Chaney is brother to F. L. Chaney, now in New Zealand. They arrived at the Sanitarium November 26, that Mrs. Chaney might take some needed treatment.

THE friends of Miss Hilda Brown, Tasmania, will be pleased to know that she is making steady progress in regaining her health.

THE Sanitarium reports a goodly number of patients, the place being nicely filled. While some have returned home benefited by the treatment received, others are coming in and taking their places.

ANOTHER of the visitors is Sister S. W. Carr, of Fiji, with two natives, Benjamina and Queenie, who arrived on December 5. Benjamina will spend a little time at the School before going on to New Guinea; while Queenie will spend a longer time at the School preparatory to entering some phase of the work. Brother Carr is expected to arrive here the early part of next year.

Union Conference Record

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE

Australasian Union Conference of Seventh Day Adventists.

"Elsnath," Burwood St., Strathfield, N. S. W., Australia.

SUBSCRIPTION RATES.

Single subscription, per year, post-paid, 4 0
Foreign Countries, per year, post-paid ($1.25) 5 0
Editor: Mrs. J. Hindson, Roland Avenue, Wahroonga, N. S. W.

Printed for the Conference by the Avondale Press, Cooranbong, N.S.W.

Dedicatory Service.

DEDICATORY exercises of the new Pacific Press factory were held in the building at 2.30 P. M., September 8. A large company of employees and friends gathered in front of the factory, and gave earnest attention to an interesting programme.

Elder H. W. Cottrell, president of the board of trustees, introduced the meeting by a few remarks, which were followed by a song by the congregation, Scripture-reading by Elder W. T. Knox, and invocation by Elder J. O. Corliss. A male double quartette rendered an original song written for the occasion. The history and work of the institution were given by the manager, C. H. Jones.

A brief synopsis of the rise and progress of the three branch offices of the Pacific Press, was given by H. H. Hall. The Kansas City branch was started in 1893, and last year the sales of this branch amounted to more than those of the home office. In 1904 the increasing demand for books and supplies in the North-west, necessitated the opening of a branch office in Portland, Oregon; and this year, owing to the difficulty experienced in getting books across the national border, another branch has been started in Regina, Saskatchewan, Canada.

A short account of the erection of the present factory building, was given by Elder O. A. Tait, and the cost of the construction was stated by H. G. Childs. The cost of the former building was about £9,375, and the expenditure on the present structure was about £4,600, or about half, and the factory floor space of the two buildings is about the same, the present one being much more conveniently arranged.

The dedicatory hymn, the words of which were written for the occasion, was sung by the congregation. This was followed by an original poem, also written for this service, and read by Miss Kathrina B. Wilcox. Elder M. C. Wilcox delivered the address, and J. N. Loughborough the dedicatory prayer.

Remarks were made by a number of those present, some of whom had been connected with the work of the Pacific Press at its very outset. After the singing of the doxology, and the benediction by Elder Knox, the friends and visitors were given an opportunity to inspect the building, and the different parts of the factory in operation.—*Pacific Union Recorder.*

From Letters Received in Reference to "Ministry of Healing."

"PLEASE find enclosed payment for another copy of 'Ministry of Healing.' I have read part of the first copy I received at the camp, and think it a most excellent book. I have learned many points I did not know before. It is certainly an excellent educator on health principles. It has given me a better knowledge of health reform than I ever had before. I am most thankful for the book."

Another writes:—

"How good the Lord is to me. I asked Him to help me sell 'Ministry of Healing.' I went out at 6.30 one morning last week, giving myself a quarter of an hour before having to be at work. I called at one place, but they were unable to take it, so I carried it to where I was going to work that day. Casually I showed it to my mistress, and asked her to look at my new book. She did so, then enquired the price. I told her it was seven shillings and sixpence. She replied, 'I will take a copy of it.' I had never thought of this, especially as she had refused 'Christ's Object Lessons,' and had told me she was tired of the *Signs*. Well, I just thank the Lord. Now will you please send me another copy. The last two weeks I could not dispose of four copies of the *Signs* from my club, so I hurried with my work on Sunday afternoon and went out with them. I sold them all, and one gentleman gave me sixpence for one copy. How good the Lord is to me. I am asking the Lord to help me canvass the Smokers' Number of the *Good Health* also. On Sabbath we sang that beautiful hymn, 'More Diligence Give Me,' and this is just what I want the Lord to do."

Another brother sent for three copies of "Ministry of Healing," and sold them readily. He wrote again:—

"Please send me three more copies of 'Ministry of Healing.' I do enjoy selling this book so much. It contains just what the people need at this time, and I feel we ought to get this book out as quickly as possible."

I have now sold forty-five copies, and am beginning to get really interested in this work and hopeful, if all will take hold of it, that it will succeed. The Spirit of God certainly works with, and helps, those who try. Now is the best time to begin.

G. B. STARR.

Obituary.

SIMPSON.—Died at the home of Mr. Edward Hare, Birkdale, Birkenhead, Auckland, on October 3, 1907, George James Simpson, son of the late David Simpson, of Melbourne, and the dearly loved husband of Sister Little Simpson, née Hare.

Brother Simpson accepted the truth in Windsor, Victoria, under the labors of Pastor W. L. H. Baker. He assisted in the erection of the first of the Avondale School buildings, being a plumber by trade. He remained four years at the School as a student. About seven years ago he came to New Zealand, and engaged in nursing work in connection with the Christchurch Sanitarium, and afterwards with Dr. E. R. Caro, at Napier.

His death was due to a rupture of the right lung, caused by overstrain while in the lighthouse service at Cape Saunders, Otago.

Twice during his illness, the members of the Auckland Young People's Society, visited him on the Sabbath (walking four and a half miles each way from Birkenhead to Birkdale) for prayers and singing of hymns, which he greatly appreciated, saying it was one of the brightest experiences of his Christian life. It was a great solace to the bereaved to watch his setting aside all hindrances to a perfect life in Christ. Brother George leaves a wife, a little son, and many relations to mourn his loss.

He now lies at rest in the Birkdale cemetery till the voice of God shall call the sleeping saints. Words of comfort were spoken at the graveside by Pastor S. M. Cobb. E. H. GUILLIARD.

"WHEN you feel spiritually or physically low, go and help some one lower than yourself."

"HE is not necessarily great, who makes few mistakes; but he is great who acknowledges his errors instead of defending them when he sees them."